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DEFENCE

READYING OUR ARMED FORCES FOR TOMORROW

Space, cyberspace, AI-enabled systems—the fields of future battles are dynamic. To meet its challenges, the indian army has to be ahead of the curve technologically and maintain quality 'boots on ground'



By **Gen. (Dr) Manoj Mukund Naravane (retd)**

Armies the world over are often accused of always fighting the 'last war'. Yet, when they crystal-gaze into the future, they are accused of watching too much science fiction. The truth, as usual, is somewhere in between. The sci-fi of yesteryear is today's reality, just as the sci-fi of today may well be the future. Warfare has evolved in time and space, with its character changing so much that a soldier of even just a generation ago will be unable to adjust to the realities of the current battlefield. Similarly, today's generation will be equally perplexed with the battlefield environment as little as 20 years down the line, as the pace of technological change today far exceeds that of the past. Preparing the armed forces of the country to be future-ready calls for harnessing insights of the past,

Illustration by **NILANJAN DAS**